

NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions
Meeting of NSC Principals Committee
DATE: November 28, 1994
LOCATION: White House Situation Room
TIME: 3:30 - 6:00pm

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

Chair
Anthony Lake

CIA
Director James Woolsey
Norman Schindler

OVP
Leon Fuerth

JCS
GEN. John Shalikashvili
LTG Dan Christman

State
Secretary Warren Christopher
Peter Tarnoff

White House
Samuel Berger
Nancy Soderberg

DOD
Secretary William Perry
Walter Slocombe

NSC
Alexander Vershbow
Donald Kerrick

UN
Ambassador Madeleine Albright
David Scheffer

Summary of Conclusions

Next Steps on Bihac

1. The Principals discussed the current situation in the Bihac region and agreed that our main goals should be to end the fighting and support efforts to negotiate measures to permit humanitarian aid to reach the besieged population. The Principals agreed not to press further for strategic air strikes to roll back Serb forces. They affirmed that the U.S. will stand by its commitment through NATO to provide Close Air Support or air strikes if requested by UNPROFOR with the proviso that appropriate action is available to NATO to deal with the Serb air defense threat.

Short-Term Strategy

2. The Principals agreed to press for a broadened diplomatic strategy based upon the following elements:

- Country-wide cessation of hostilities for at least three months, and preferably six months, tied to a reinvigorated diplomatic effort.
- Demilitarization of the Bihac safe area within its established limits, to be enforced by existing UNPROFOR troops, possibly with limited augmentation by Dutch or other NATO-country elements with TACP capabilities.
- Bosnian Serb agreement to provide unimpeded access for humanitarian relief convoys to all safe areas and other hard-pressed areas of Bosnia, including opening the "blue route" for commercial access to Sarajevo.
- Bosnian Government agreement to comply with previous demilitarization agreements around Sarajevo.
- Renewed diplomatic contacts with all parties by the Contact Group (and/or through the convening of an international conference).
 - While we would end the freeze on contacts with the Bosnian Serbs, the Contact Group map would remain as the starting point for negotiations on territory; nevertheless, the Contact Group could explore informally possible land swaps on the basis of mutual consent among the parties.
 - The Contact Group would make clear that constitutional principles and the question of links to neighboring states would be on the table, on the basis of "balanced" treatment for the Bosniac-Croat Federation and the Bosnian Serb entity.
- A modified "Plan B" should still be offered to Milosevic.
 - However, in return for U.S. agreement to the EU's front-loaded approach to sanctions relief, we should insist on more stringent conditions, possibly to include Bosnian Serb compliance with cessation of hostilities and humanitarian access agreements, as well as steps purely in Milosevic's control (mutual recognition, support for Z-4 plan, etc.).
 - We will also insist on short periods for sanctions suspension and a credible mechanism for reimposing the sanctions if Milosevic ceases to comply with the conditions.

- We will also press Milosevic to cut off support for the Krajina Serbs, including closing the Serbian-Croatian border in Sector East, with the sanctioning of international monitors.
- Final litmus tests should be laid down by Contact Group as the basis for a decision in January (at the end of 100-day period) on whether to extend the limited sanctions relief that is now in effect for Serbia. We should demand much stricter compliance than currently being demonstrated, including "zero option" for fuel and military shipments to the Bosnian Serbs, physical closure of most crossings, and perhaps agreement to increase the number of monitors.
- We should warn Milosevic that sanctions tightening, and not just an end to sanctions suspension, will occur if we are not satisfied at the 100-day mark.
- We should press forward with efforts to contain spillover: push Z-4 plan, press for Belgrade dialogue with Kosovo Albanians, strengthen support for Macedonia.

Longer-Term Strategy

3. The Principals deferred decision on steps to take should the short-term approach fail to produce desired progress. The Principals were asked to consider the following elements, or a combination thereof, of a longer-term strategy as a basis for discussion at a future meeting:

- Multilateral lift and strike, preceded by an orderly (NATO-assisted) departure of UNPROFOR. U.S. would set time limit for its military support and air involvement (1-2 years), after which Bosnians would be on their own. Diplomatic efforts would continue in the hope that lift would bring Bosnian Serbs to their senses.
- Reinforcement of UNPROFOR and redefinition of its mission so that NATO air power can be used more aggressively on the basis of its current mandates. (This might have to include a U.S. ground force commitment, unless we would want a largely Islamic-country force).
- U.S. disengagement from diplomatic efforts, focus on containment of spillover to Croatia and Kosovo. Plan for maintaining sanctions against Serbia and Bosnian Serbs for the long term, with international community refusing to recognize Serb territorial conquests. UNPROFOR would remain in a purely humanitarian role, to the extent possible.

Dealing with NATO and Allies

U.S. - NATO Relationship

4. The Principals discussed the impact of recent events in Bosnia on NATO and strongly reaffirmed the importance of the alliance to the United States, recognizing that future U.S. involvement in Bosnia should be conducted in concert with our allies.

Impact of Nunn-Mitchell on NATO

Principals acknowledged allied concerns that Nunn-Mitchell was the first step leading to unilateral lifting of the arms embargo which could have serious consequences on the alliance. They agreed to make strong statements opposing unilateral lift in the upcoming Ministerials and in public.

U.S. Participation in NATO Ground Operations in Bosnia

The Principals reviewed the state of planning at NATO and within UNPROFOR for the withdrawal of UNPROFOR forces from Bosnia should that be required. They recognized that uncertainty surrounding U.S. ground forces participation in a NATO operation to assist UNPROFOR withdrawal required clarification. They agreed to recommend to the President that he authorize Secretaries Christopher and Perry to inform the allies that the U.S. agreed to participate in such an operation in principle, to include ground forces, pending review of the plan, alternatives and Congressional consultants. Action: OSD/JCS to prepare paper summarizing current state of NATO/UNPROFOR military planning and framing degree of U.S. commitment as a basis for decision memo for the President.

Dealing with Congress and the Public

5. The Principals agreed that efforts should continue to raise the awareness in Congress about the implications of unilateral lifting of the arms embargo and to strongly oppose unilateral lift in public and in Congressional consultations. Secretary Perry will begin the next round of consultations this week using his weekly breakfast with key members. The Principals further agreed to DoD hosting private sessions with key members. The Principals directed that talking points be prepared outlining next steps in Bosnia. Action: NSC to develop talking points.

Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

This is not a presidential record. This is used as an administrative marker by the William J. Clinton Presidential Library Staff.

Documents from this Mandatory Declassification Review were released in full or released in part.

Those documents released with redactions have been restricted under Section 1.4 (c) of E.O. 13526 and (b)(3) of the FOIA.
